PORTFOLIO SAMPLE · FICTIONAL COMPANY · NAMES AND FIGURES ARE INVENTED

Customer Advisory Board Playbook

How Northwind runs its customer advisory board for 28 CIOs and CTOs, in the order the work happens. Ten stages, one program year.

> THE ONE RULE
>
> Every ask a member makes gets an answer, even when the answer is no.

ORDER OF OPERATIONS

01	Aug to Sep	**Nominations**
02	Oct	**Membership selection** account analysis
03	Nov	**Campaign setup** CRM tracking
04	Dec	**Leadership review**
05	Jan to Feb	**Member onboarding**
06	Feb	**Agenda curation**
07	Feb to Apr	**Content curation**
08	May	**Annual meeting** planning and execution
09	Quarterly	**Member webinars**
10	Nov to Dec	**User conference** members-only program

01

Aug to Sep

Nominations

Account teams nominate senior technical leaders for next year's board.

OWNER Program manager opens the cycle. Account teams nominate.

DONE Nominations closed. Each one has a written justification.

AI Summarizes every justification into one comparable view.

Renewals first. Draft the renewal list before opening nominations, so account teams know how many seats are open.

02

Oct

Membership selection

Score every nominee and returning member against the same account data.

TAS
Total addressable spend. Room to grow.

TTM spend
Trailing 12 months. Current scale.

Role and fit
Decision scope, technical depth, last cycle's engagement.

OWNER Program manager, with business operations for the spend data.

DONE A ranked list of renewals, retirements, and new seats.

AI Pulls each nominee's account history from the CRM into a one-page profile.

Data ranks the list. Judgment sets the room. Balance industry, region, and company size so members see peers.

03

Nov

Campaign setup

Build the CRM campaigns that tag each member account, so engagement and pipeline are tracked all year.

OWNER Program manager.

DONE One campaign per touchpoint. Members added. Statuses defined.

Set it up before the first invitation. Engagement that isn't tagged on day one can't be reported later.

04

Dec

Leadership review

Executive sponsors approve the roster, the retirements, and the year's goals.

OWNER	Program manager prepares it. Sponsors decide.
DONE	Written sign-off on the roster.
AI	Drafts the decision document from the tracker. The program manager edits.

Bring a decision document, not a deck. Recommendation first, data behind it, decisions needed at the end. The same format returns for the agenda review and the debrief.

05

Jan to Feb

Member onboarding

Tell account teams the decisions, then invite members and bring new ones up to speed.

OWNER	Program manager. Account teams confirm the NDA.
DONE	Every member registered, under NDA, and clear on the year ahead.

Account teams hear first. No seller should learn about their customer's invitation from the customer.

06

Feb

Agenda curation

Pick sessions from two sources: what members asked for last year, and what product teams need to learn.

OWNER	Program manager, with a core planning team.
DONE	Agenda approved by sponsors. One owner per session.

Every session ends in a question for members. A session that asks nothing is a keynote. Move it to a webinar.

07

Feb to Apr

Content curation

Session owners write the pre-reads. The program manager runs the gates and reviews every draft.



OWNER	Session owners from product teams.
DONE	Pre-reads in members' hands three weeks out.
AI	First-pass review of each draft against the template, before human review.

Write for both readers. Deep enough for a CTO. Plain enough for a CIO to repeat to their board.

08

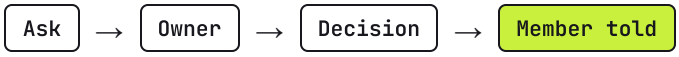
May

Annual meeting

Two days, 12 sessions. Members face each other. Northwind's leaders listen from the gallery.

OWNER	Program manager onsite. The events agency runs logistics.
DONE	Notes for every session. Survey sent before members leave. Recaps out within two weeks.
AI	Turns session notes into one row per ask, tagged by product.

Close the loop after. Every ask gets a row, a product owner, and an answer back to the member.



THE NUMBER TO WATCH

Closure lag

The days between a product team's decision and the member hearing about it. Teams decide, then nobody tells the customer. That gap ends advisory boards quietly. Track it on every ask.

STAY CLOSE ALL YEAR

09 Member webinars

Quarterly

One virtual session a quarter keeps members engaged between meetings.

Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4
Year preview	What we heard	You asked, we did	Roadmap update

Close the loop in public. Show members what changed because of them. Invite a member to co-present.

10 User conference

Nov to Dec

A members-only program inside Northwind's annual conference: one session with the CEO and a member dinner.

OWNER	Program manager, with the conference team.
DONE	Members registered. Dinner seated. A briefing doc for every leader attending.
AI	An agent drafts each briefing doc from CRM data. The account manager reviews it.

Seat members next to leaders they don't know yet. New relationships are a goal of the board, so seating is planned like an agenda.

WHAT THE PROGRAM MEASURES

Renewal rate	Target 75%+. Members think the board is worth their time.
Session ratings	Target 4.5 of 5. Which sessions earned the room.
Loop-closure rate	Target 90% within 60 days. Members heard back.
Engaged pipeline	Trend, not target. Reported as correlation, not cause.

THE SAME TEN STAGES RUN CUSTOMER ADVOCACY

CAB STAGE	IN AN ADVOCACY PROGRAM
Nominations, selection	Account teams nominate customers with a story. Score them on outcome, brand, and willingness to go public.
Content, annual meeting	The case study, video, or conference talk, with legal and customer approvals as the gates.
Close the loop	Send the customer the published piece and how far it traveled.